MicFlow

Install guide for Mac and Android

Install MicFlow, sign in with Google, get voice typing working, and fix the problems people most often hit along the way.

What's inside

1. Mac: download, open it the first time, sign in
2. Android: download, get past Play Protect, allow the permissions, sign in
3. Signing in and your voice key: problems and how to fix them
4. Updates and notifications

Why the extra steps? MicFlow is free and isn't sold through Apple's App Store or Google Play, so your Mac and phone ask you to confirm that you trust it. This guide shows exactly what to tap.

1 • MicFlow on your Mac

About 3 minutes. You'll need your Mac's login password once.

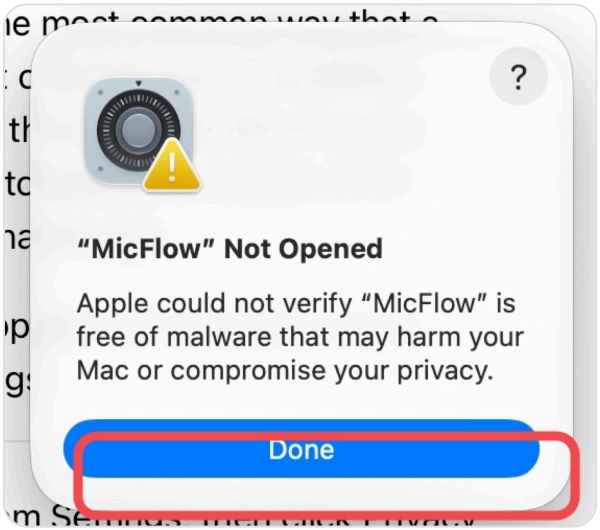
Download and install

1. Go to **github.com/abdulllahel/MicFlow/releases/latest** and download `MicFlow-x.x.dmg` (the number is the version).
2. Open the downloaded file and drag **MicFlow** onto the **Applications** folder in the same window.

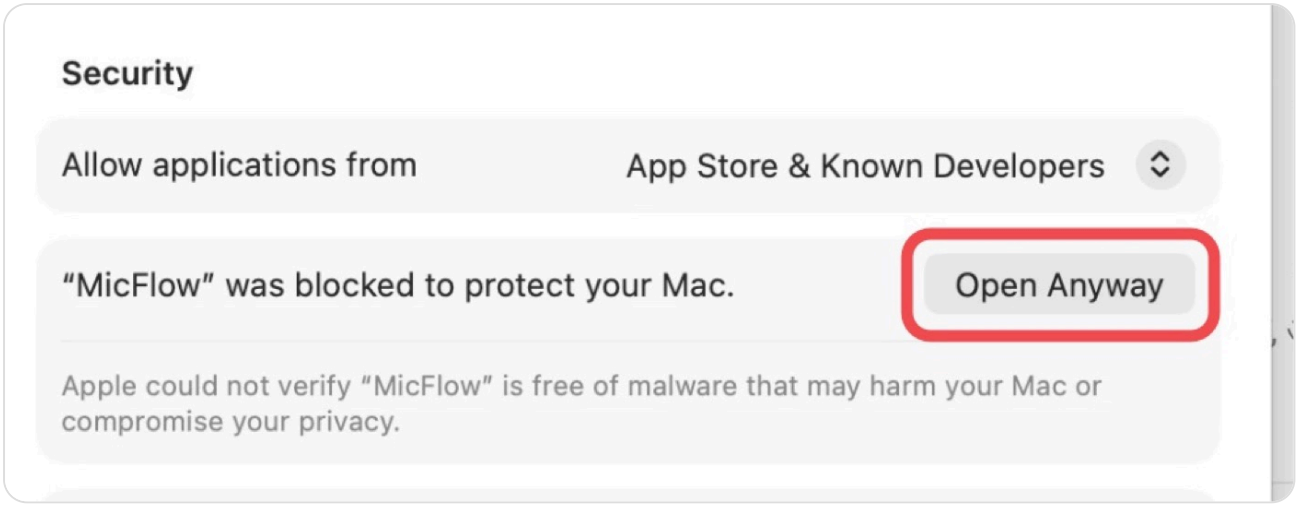
Open it the first time

Apple checks every app from outside the App Store. Because MicFlow isn't signed with Apple's paid developer certificate, macOS blocks it the first time. Here's how to allow it once.

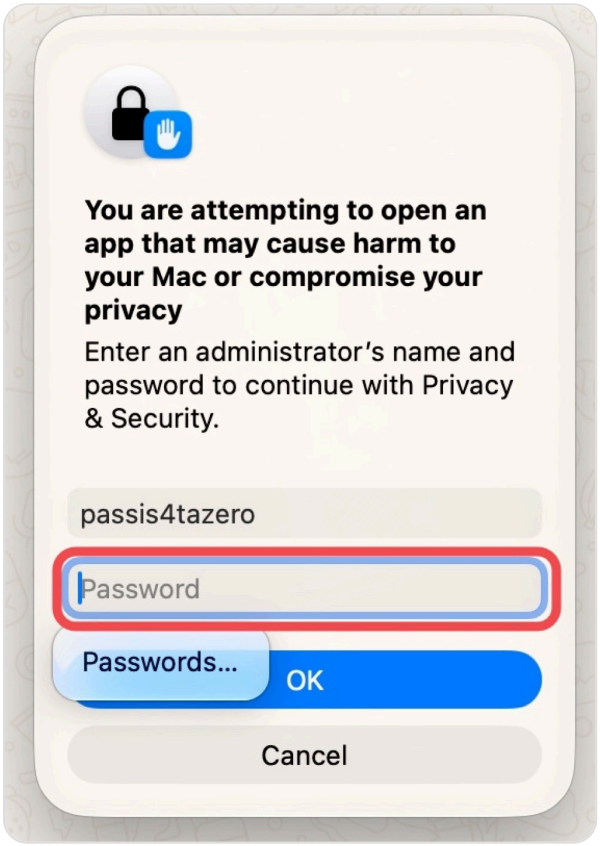
3. Open MicFlow from Applications. macOS says **"MicFlow" Not Opened**. Click **Done** (not Move to Trash).



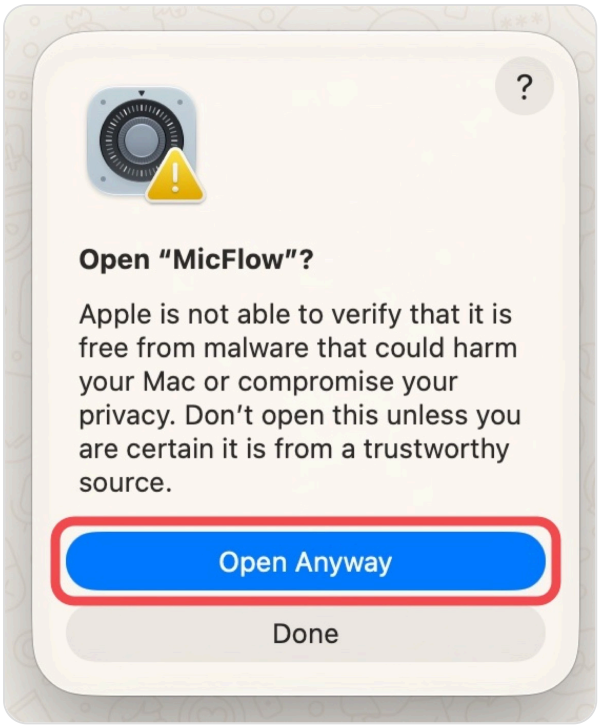
4 Open **System Settings › Privacy & Security** and scroll down to **Security**. Next to "*MicFlow*" *was blocked to protect your Mac*, click **Open Anyway**. (This button is there for about an hour after you tried to open MicFlow.)



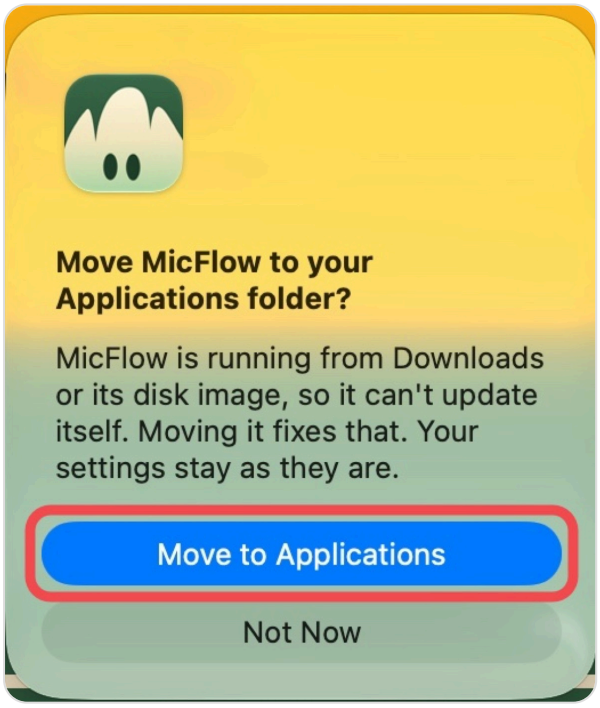
5 Enter your Mac's login password and click **OK**.



6 macOS asks once more: **Open "MicFlow"?** Click **Open Anyway**. From now on MicFlow opens normally.



7 If MicFlow says it's running from Downloads or the disk image, click **Move to Applications**. That lets it update itself later.



Allow the microphone and Accessibility

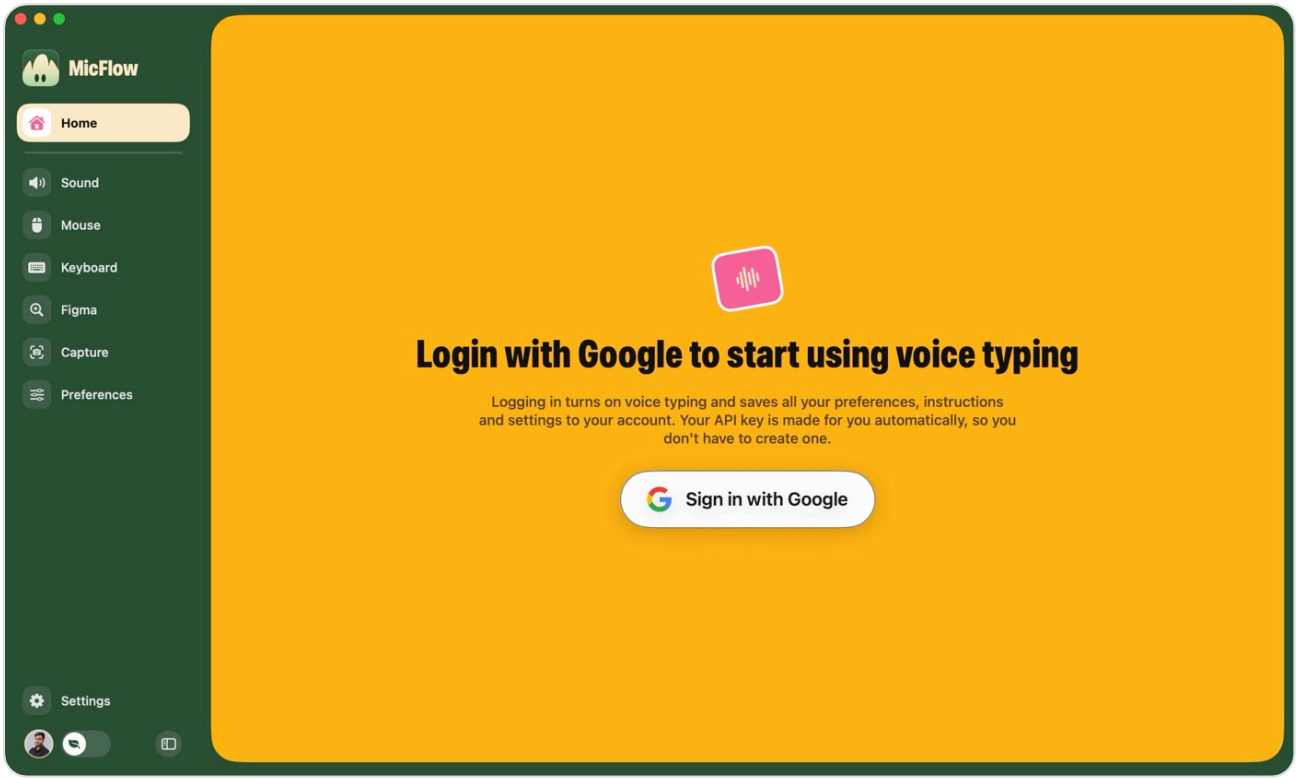
8 When macOS asks to let MicFlow use the **microphone**, click **Allow**.

9 For the voice key (hold a key and talk), MicFlow needs **Accessibility**: open **System Settings** › **Privacy & Security** › **Accessibility** and turn on **MicFlow**. MicFlow shows a button that opens this page for you.

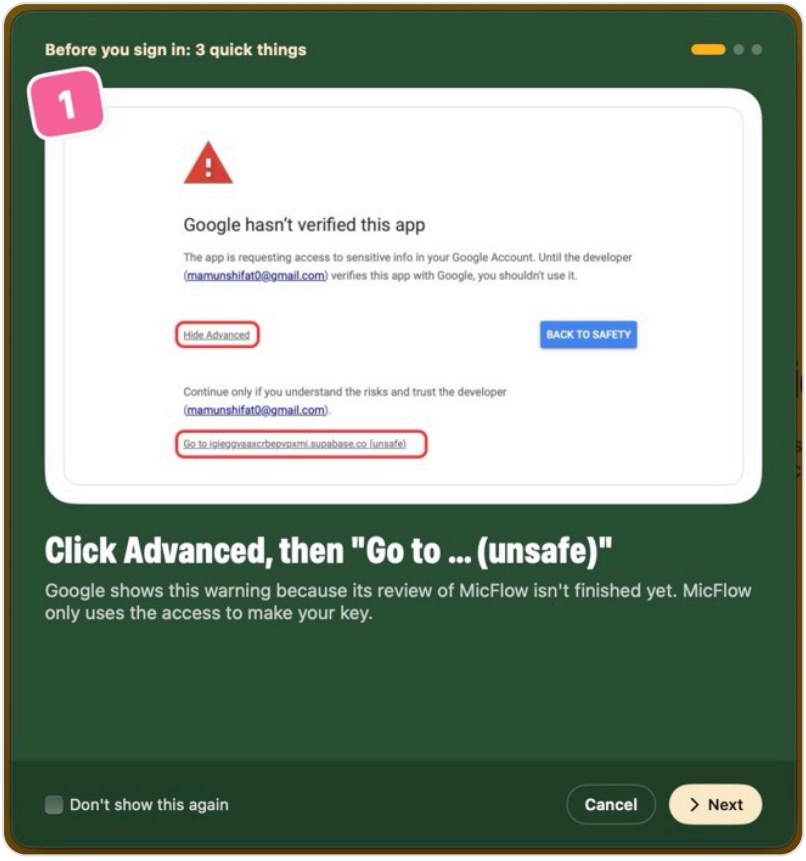
Keychain question? If macOS asks whether MicFlow may use its saved items in your Keychain (for example after an update), enter your password and click **Always Allow**. That's where MicFlow keeps your sign-in and your key.

Sign in and start voice typing

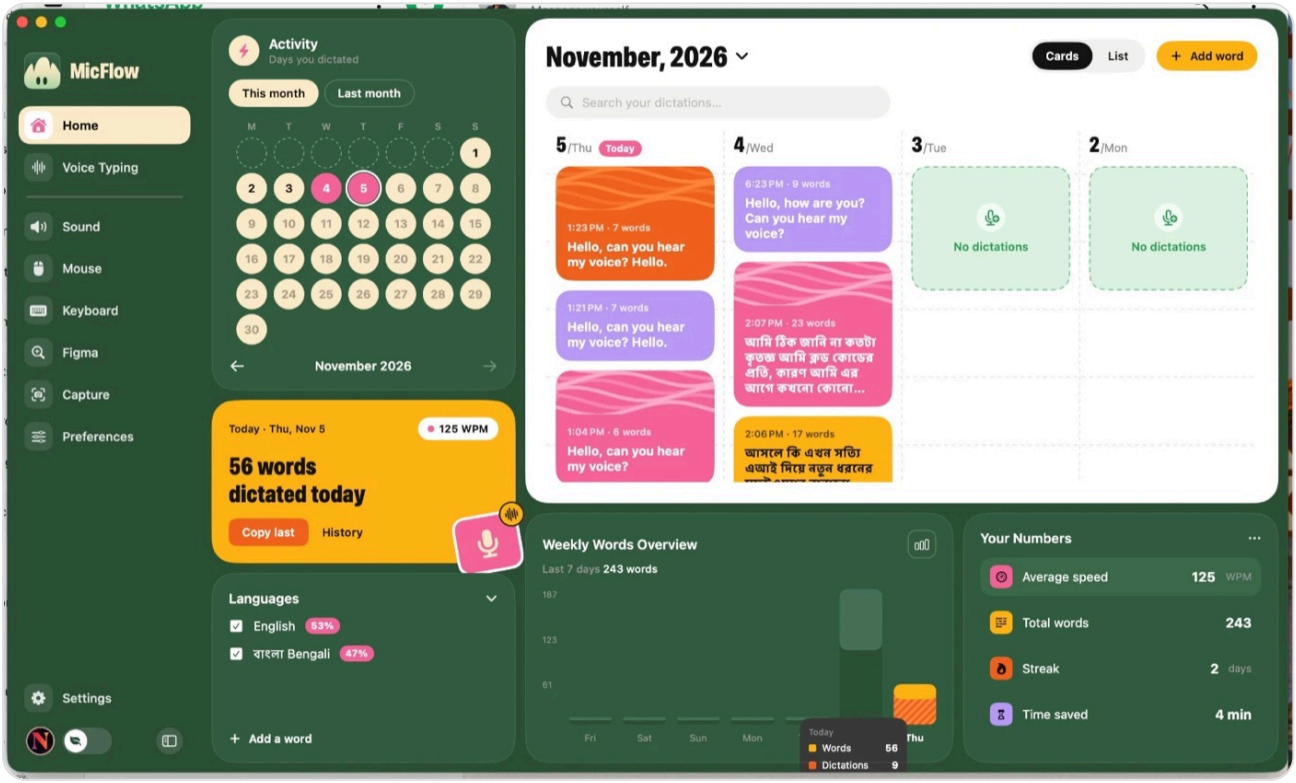
10 On Home, click **Sign in with Google**. Signing in turns on voice typing, makes your free voice key for you, and saves your settings to your account.



11 MicFlow first shows three short slides about Google's screens; click **Next** through them, then **Continue with Google**. The same steps are explained below in section 3.



12 When it's done, Home shows your dashboard. Hold your voice key (Right Ctrl unless you changed it), talk, and let go: your words are typed where your cursor is.

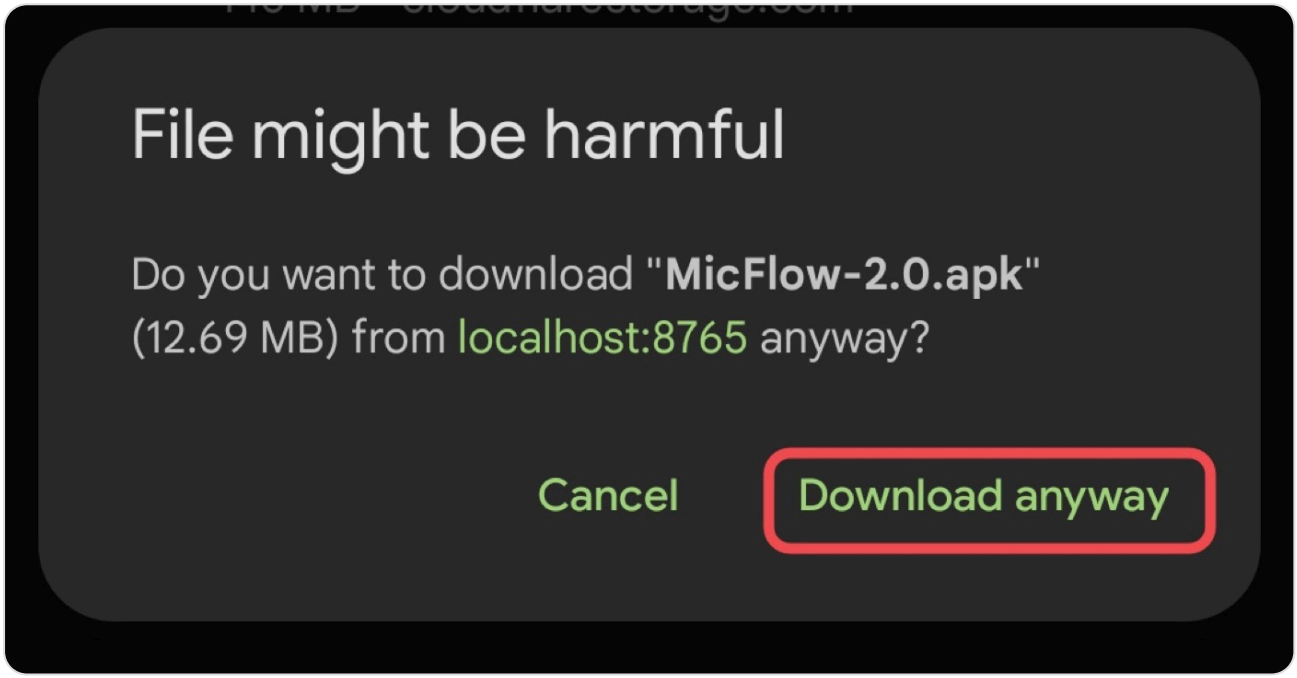


2 • MicFlow on Android

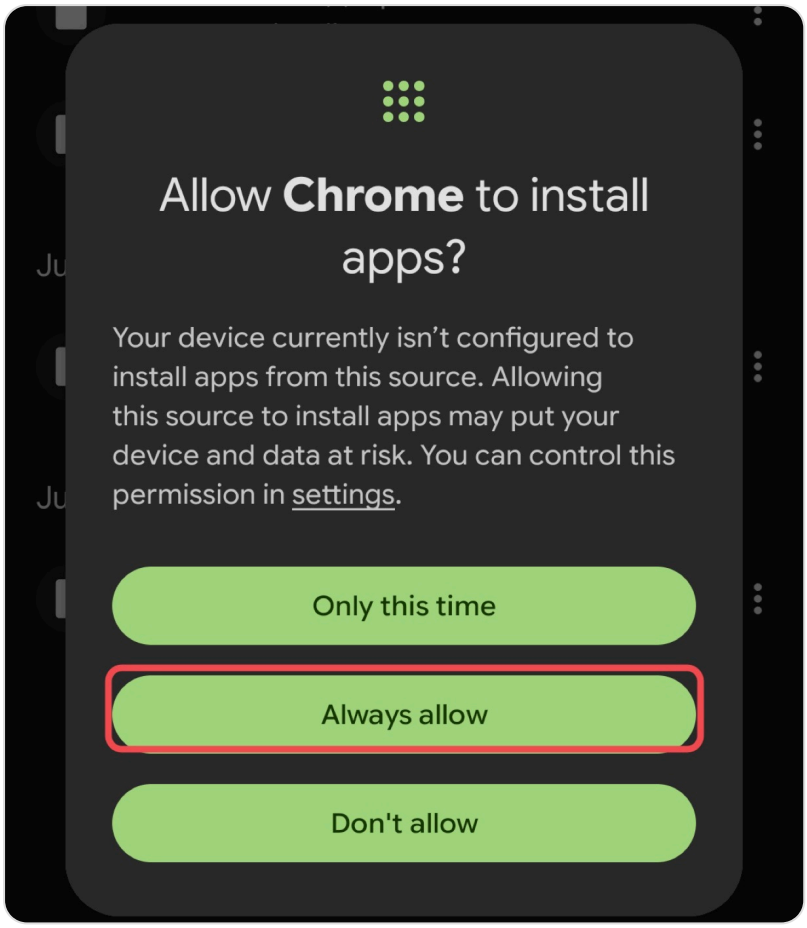
About 5 minutes. Pictures are from a Pixel; other phones look a little different but the steps are the same.

Download

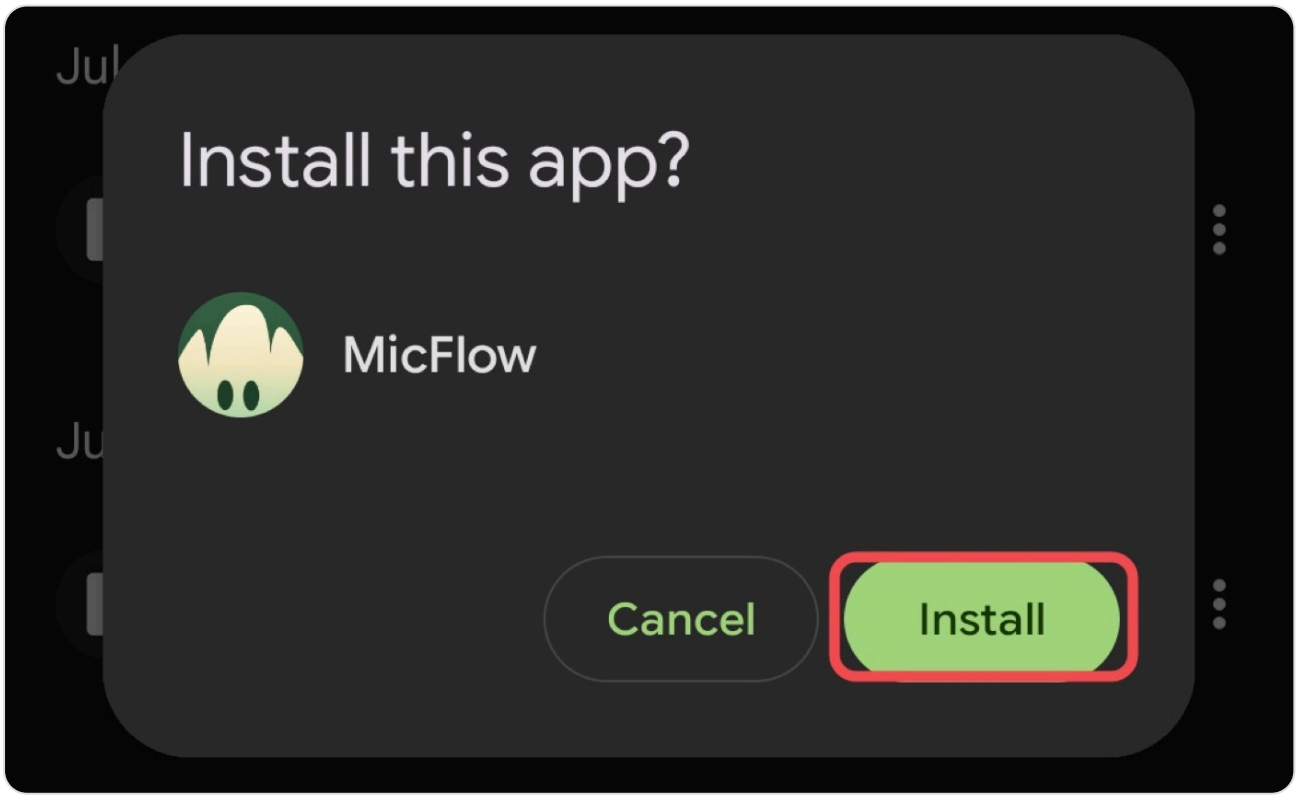
1. In Chrome on your phone, open **github.com/abdulllahel/MicFlow-Android/releases/latest** and tap `MicFlow-x.x.apk`. Chrome warns **File might be harmful**: tap **Download anyway**. (In the picture the file comes from a test computer; yours will say github.com.)



2 Tap the downloaded file. The first time, Android asks **Allow Chrome to install apps?** Tap **Only this time** or **Always allow**.

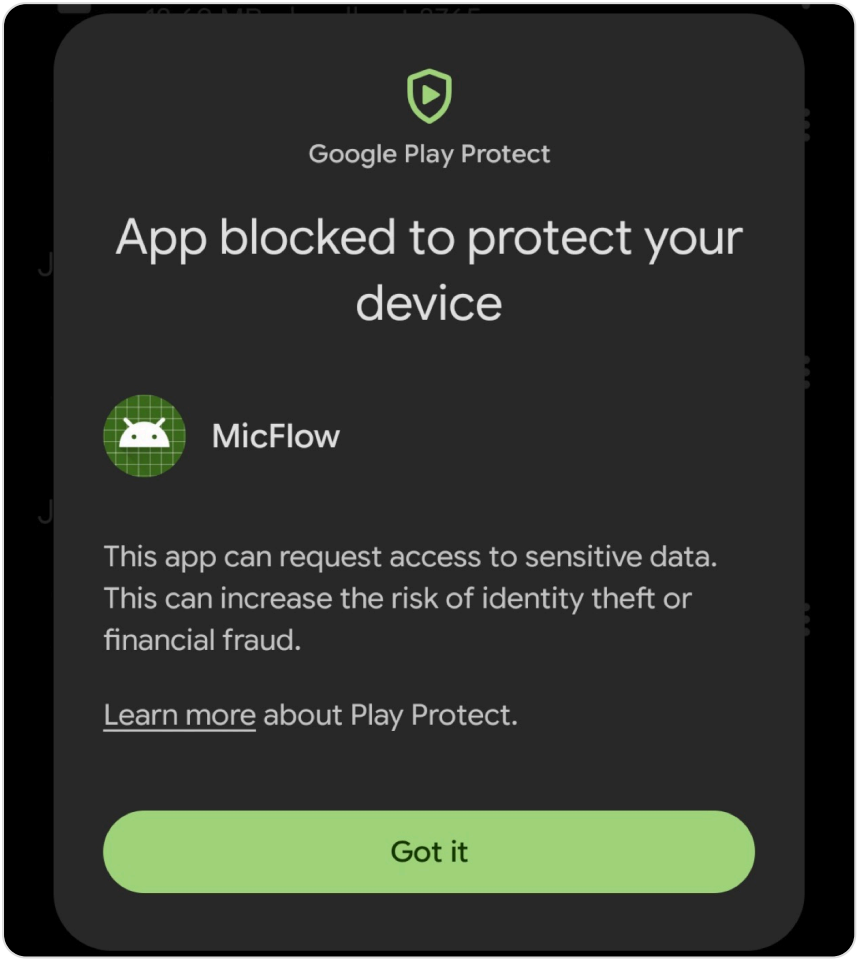


3 Tap **Install**.

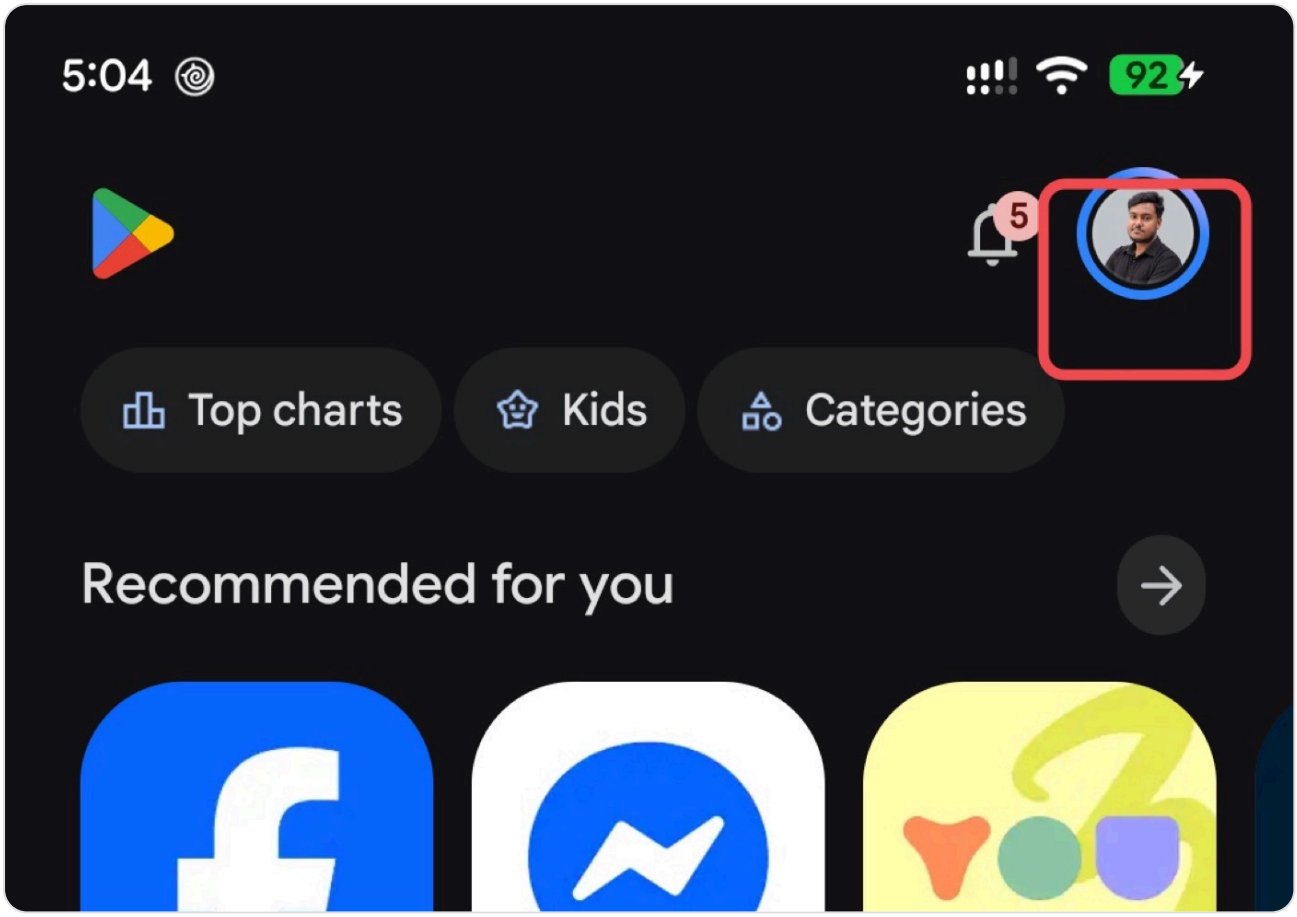


If Play Protect blocks it

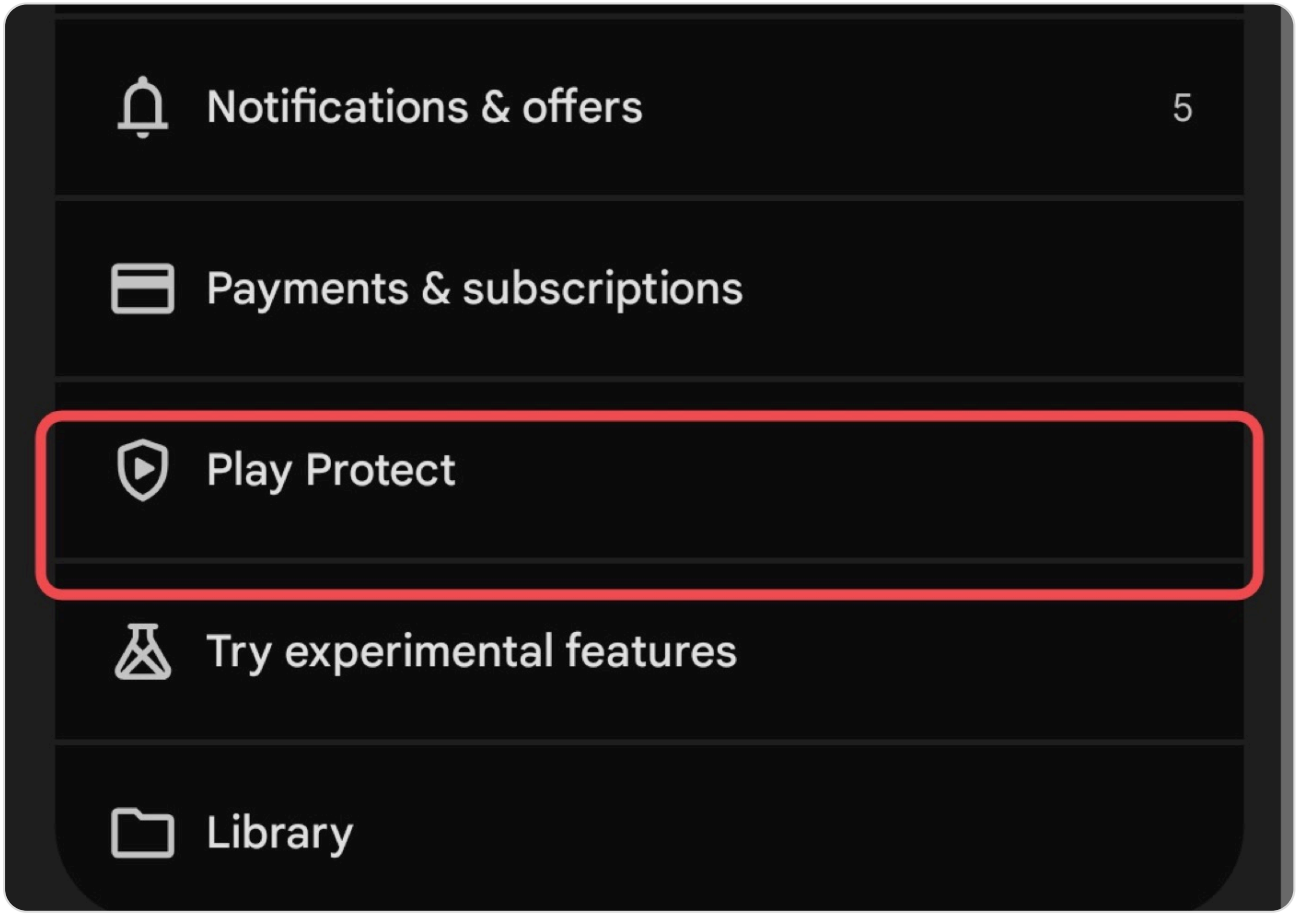
Google Play Protect may stop apps from outside the Play Store that ask for Accessibility, with **App blocked to protect your device** and only a **Got it** button. Tap **Got it**, then pause Play Protect's scanning for a moment:



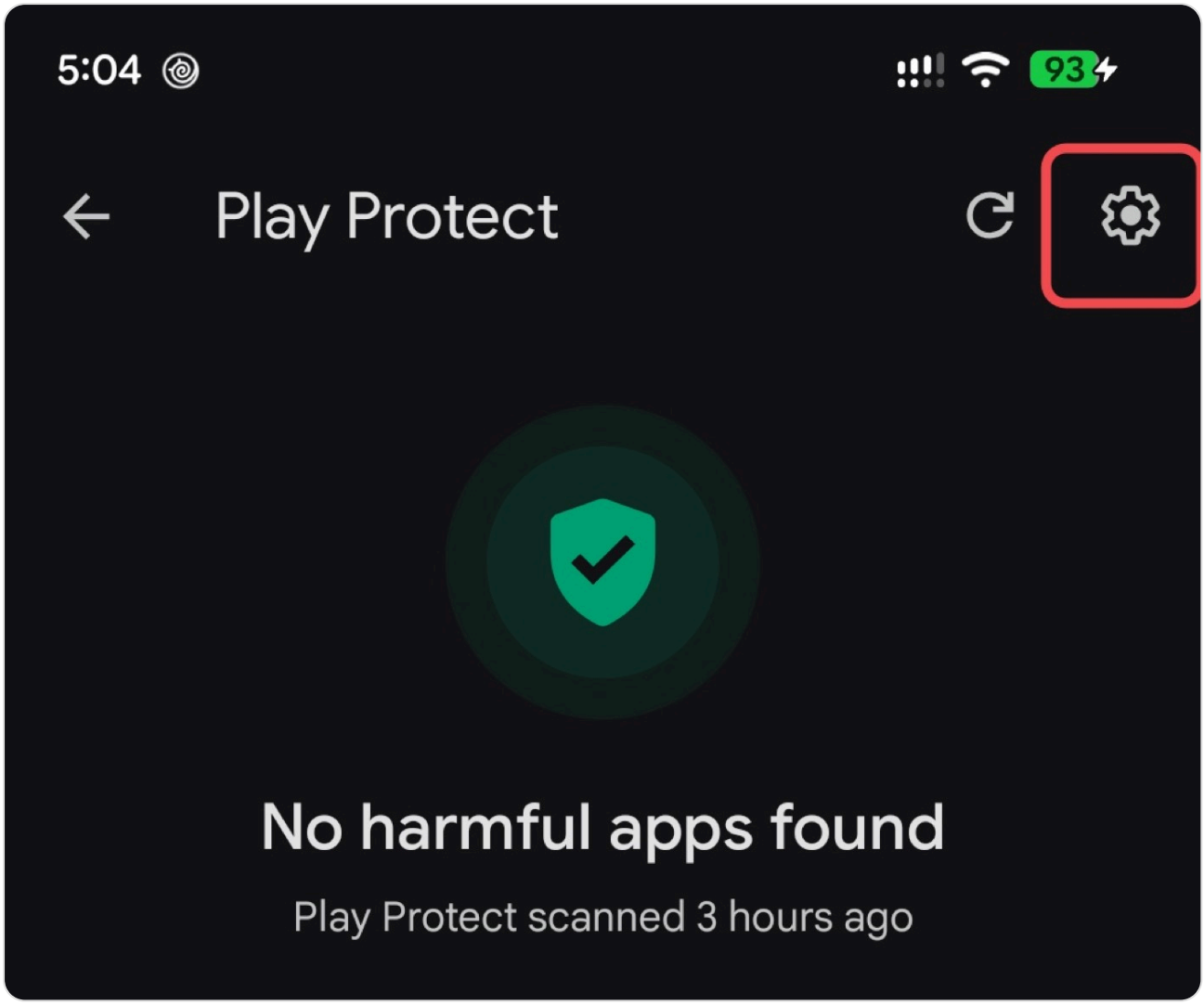
4 Open the **Play Store** and tap your **profile picture** at the top right.



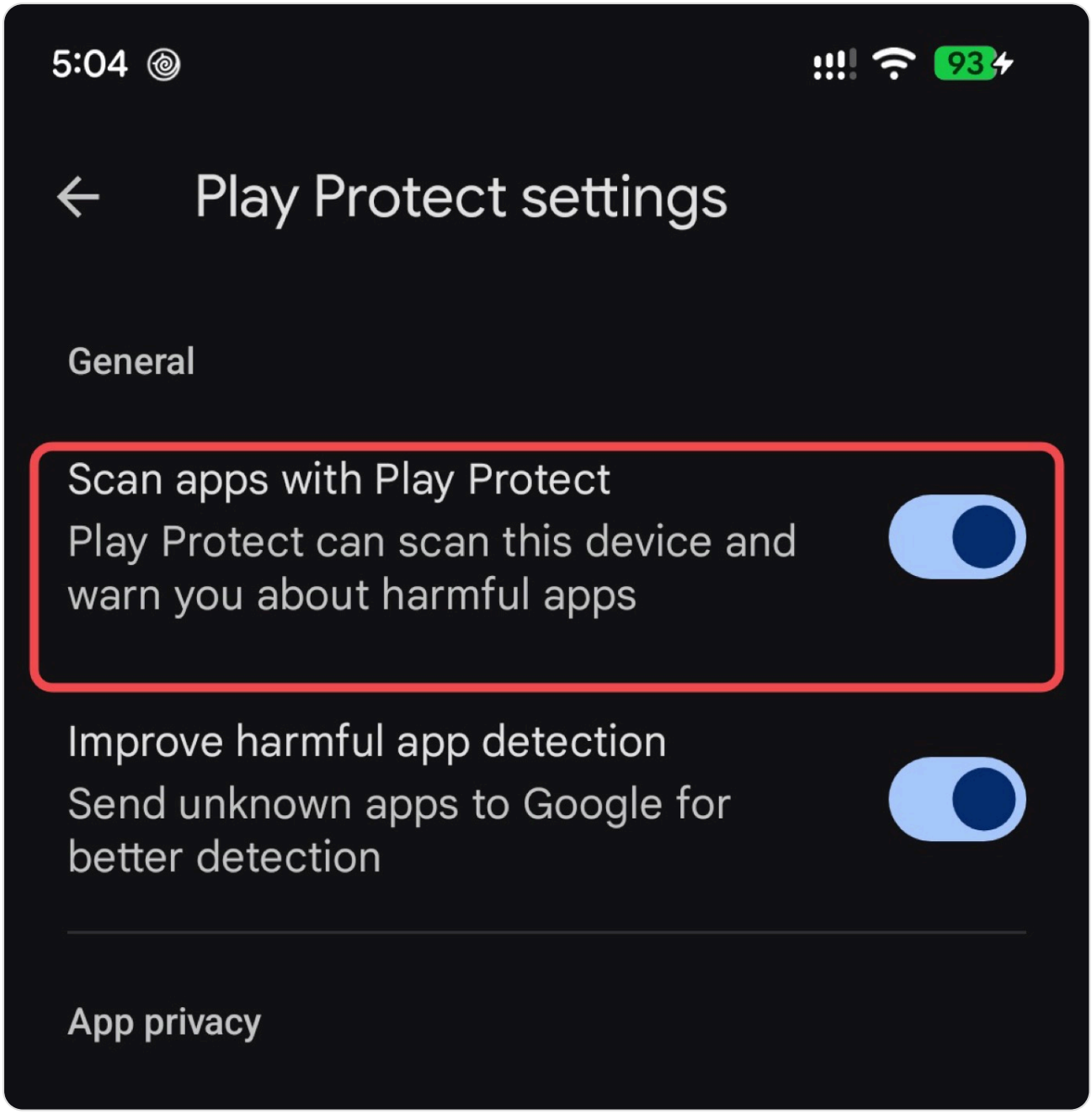
5 Tap **Play Protect**.



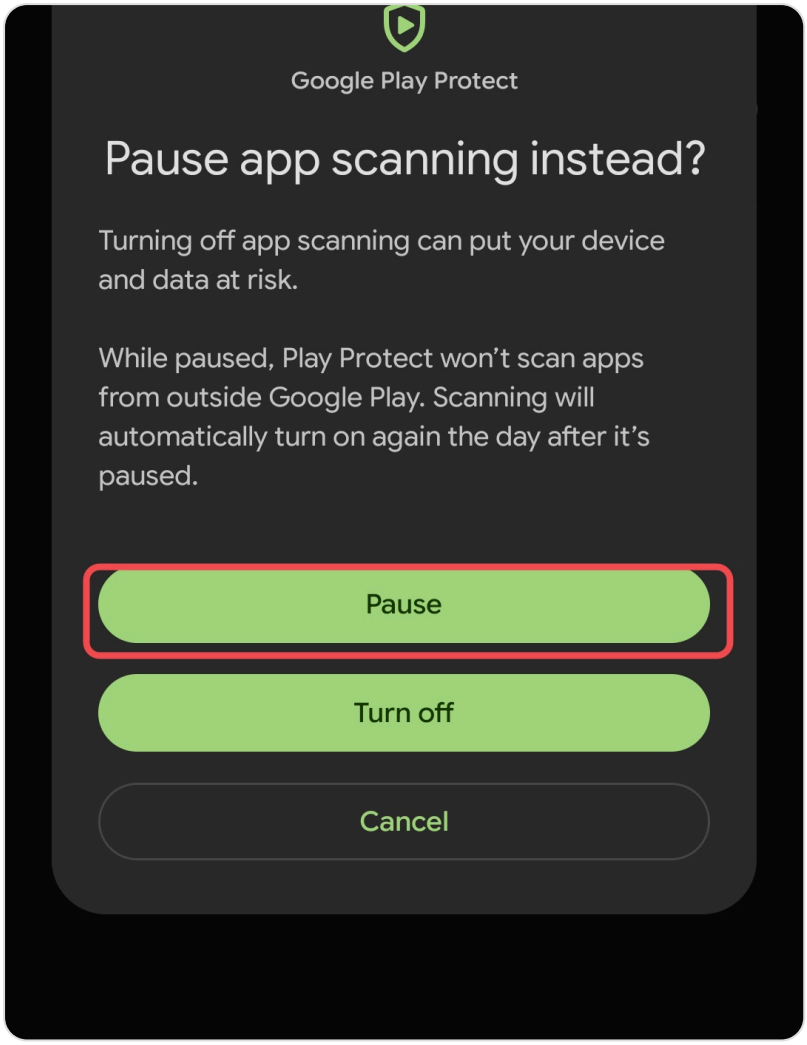
6 Tap the **gear** at the top right.



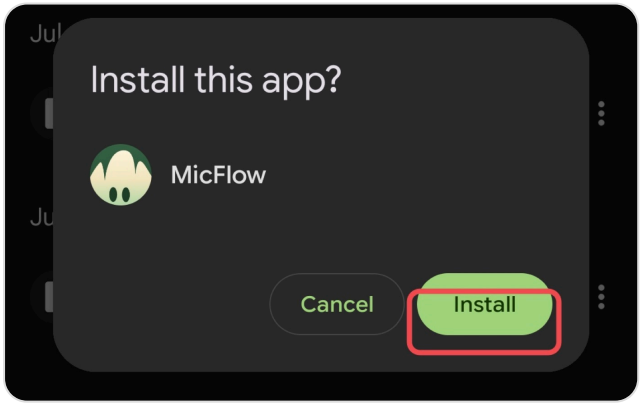
7 Turn off **Scan apps with Play Protect**.

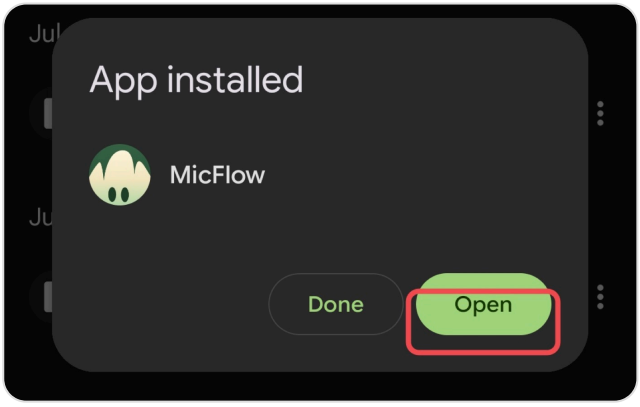


8 Choose **Pause**: scanning turns itself back on the next day, so you can't forget it.



9 Go back to Chrome's downloads, tap the MicFlow file again and tap **Install**, then **Open**.

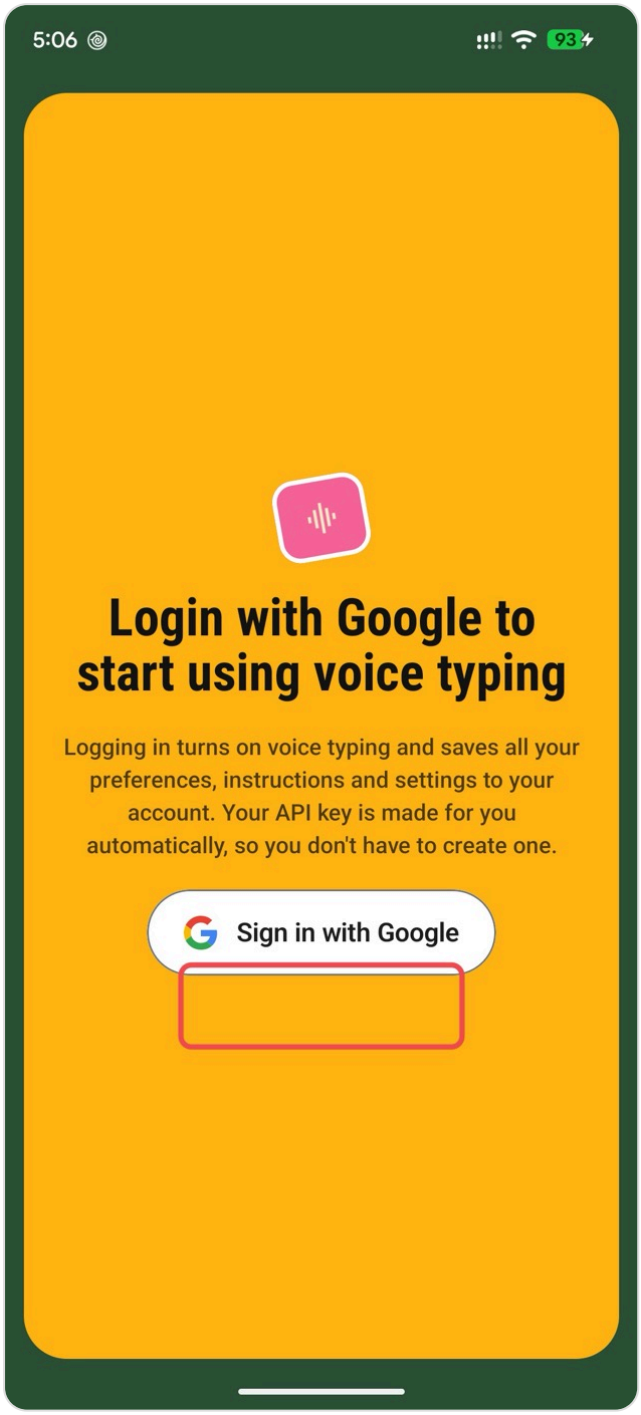


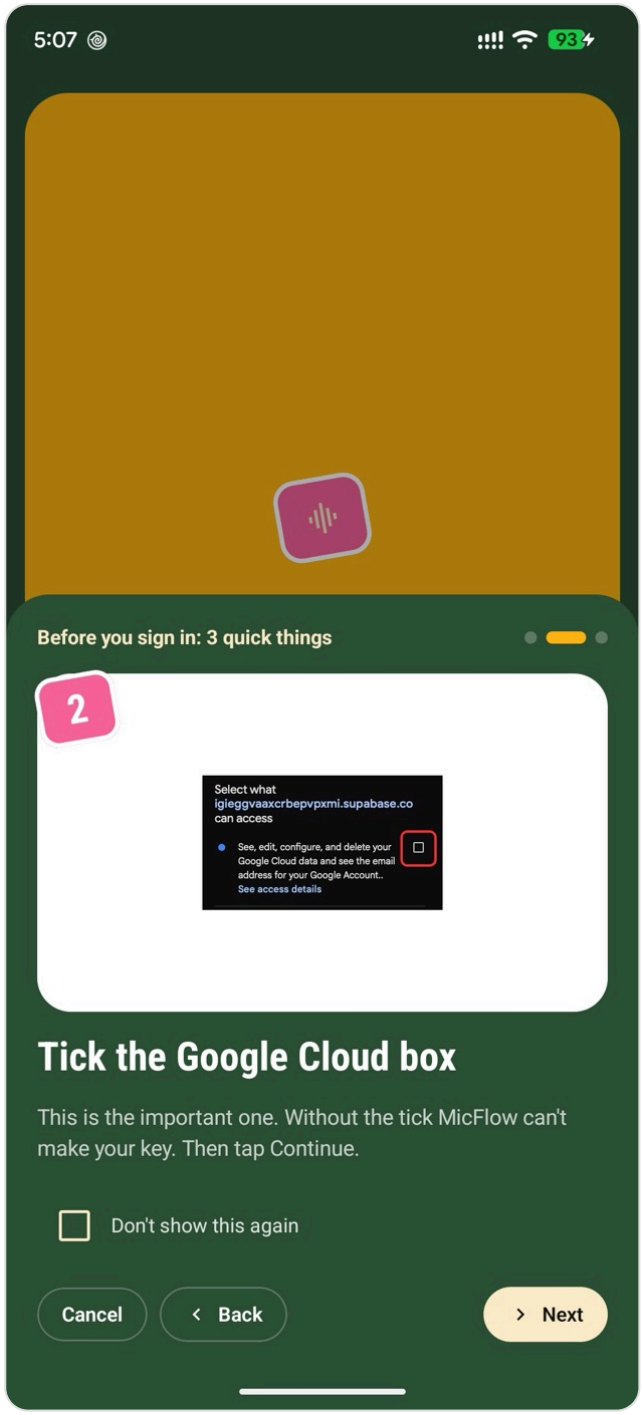


If you chose **Turn off** instead of Pause, turn **Scan apps with Play Protect** back on now (and **Improve harmful app detection**, if you switched that off too). Play Protect doesn't remove MicFlow once it's installed.

Sign in

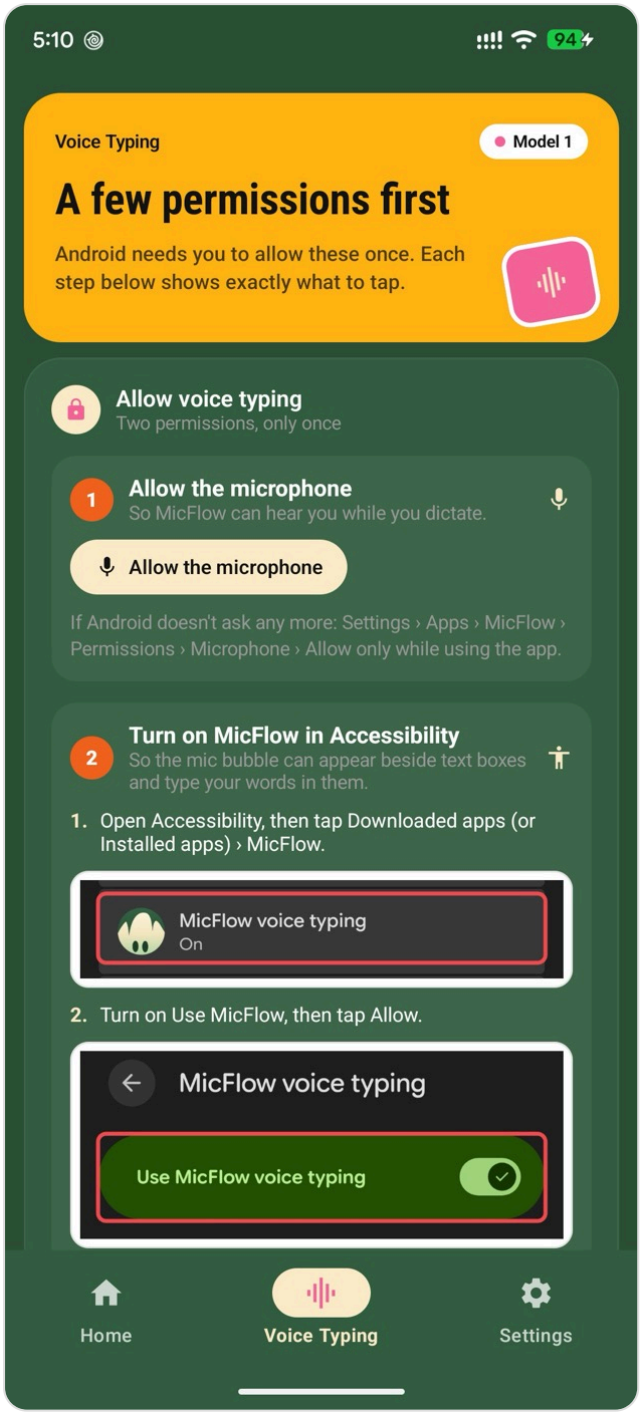
10 MicFlow opens on its login screen. Tap **Sign in with Google**, go through the three slides, and follow Google's screens (section 3 explains each one). If you already use MicFlow on a Mac with the same Google account, your key and settings come over by themselves.

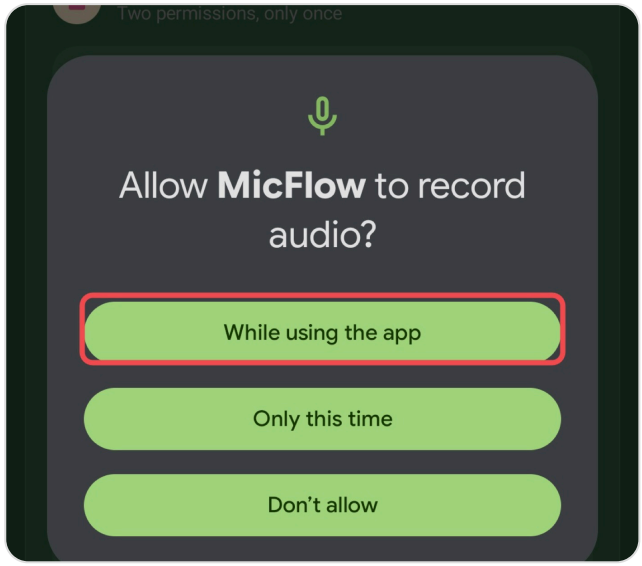




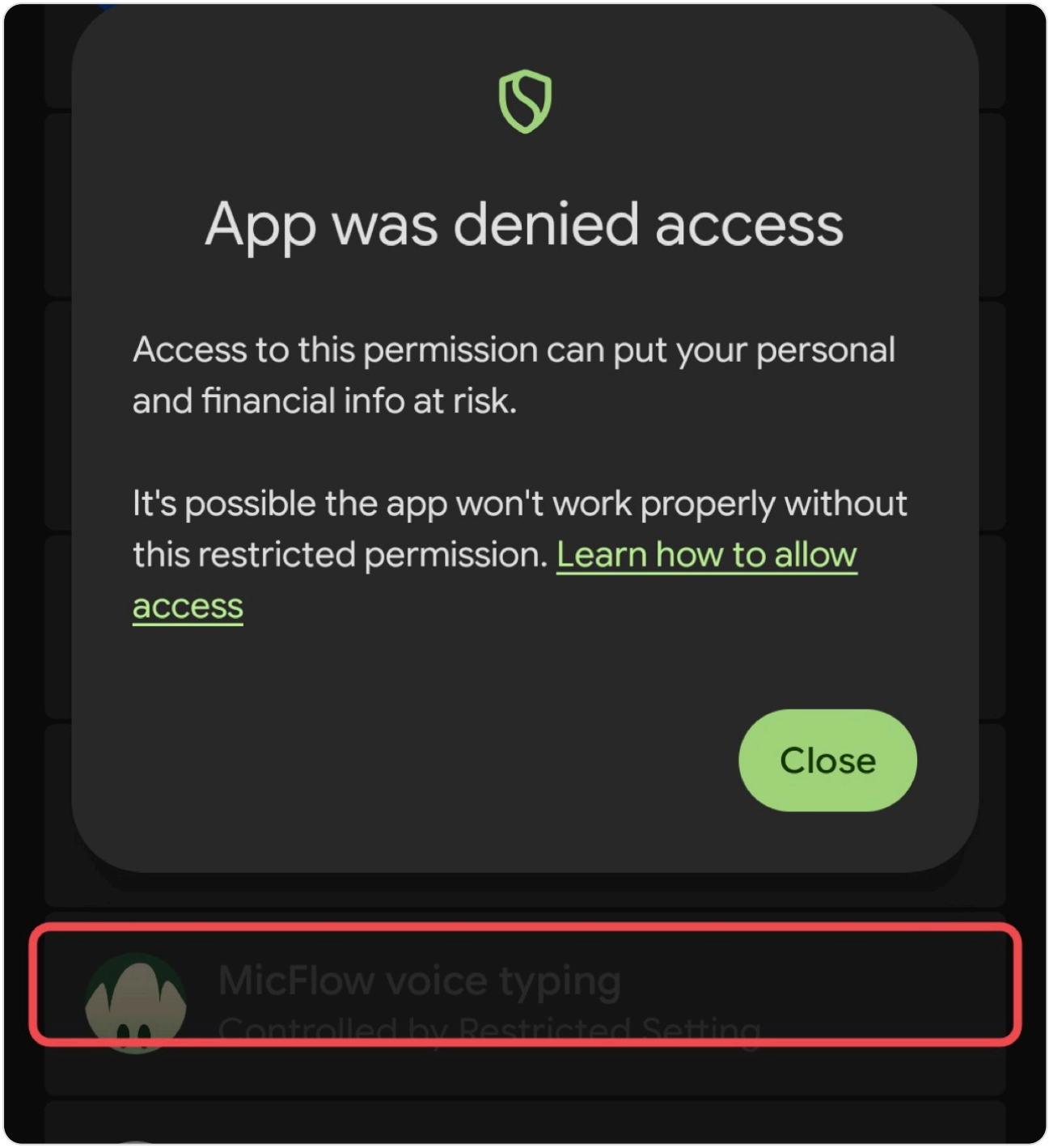
Allow the permissions

11 Open the **Voice Typing** tab. It lists what Android still needs, with pictures. Tap **Allow the microphone**, then **While using the app**. Also allow **notifications** when asked, for updates and news.

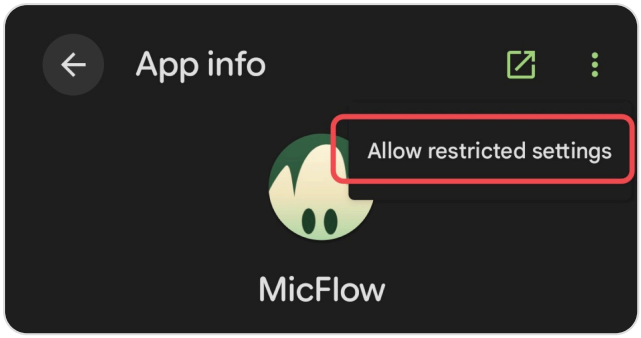


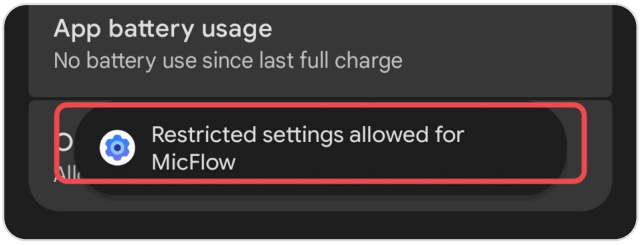


12 Tap **Open Accessibility**, then **MicFlow voice typing**. Because MicFlow came from a download, Android first says **App was denied access** and shows MicFlow greyed out (*Controlled by Restricted Setting*). Tap **Close**.

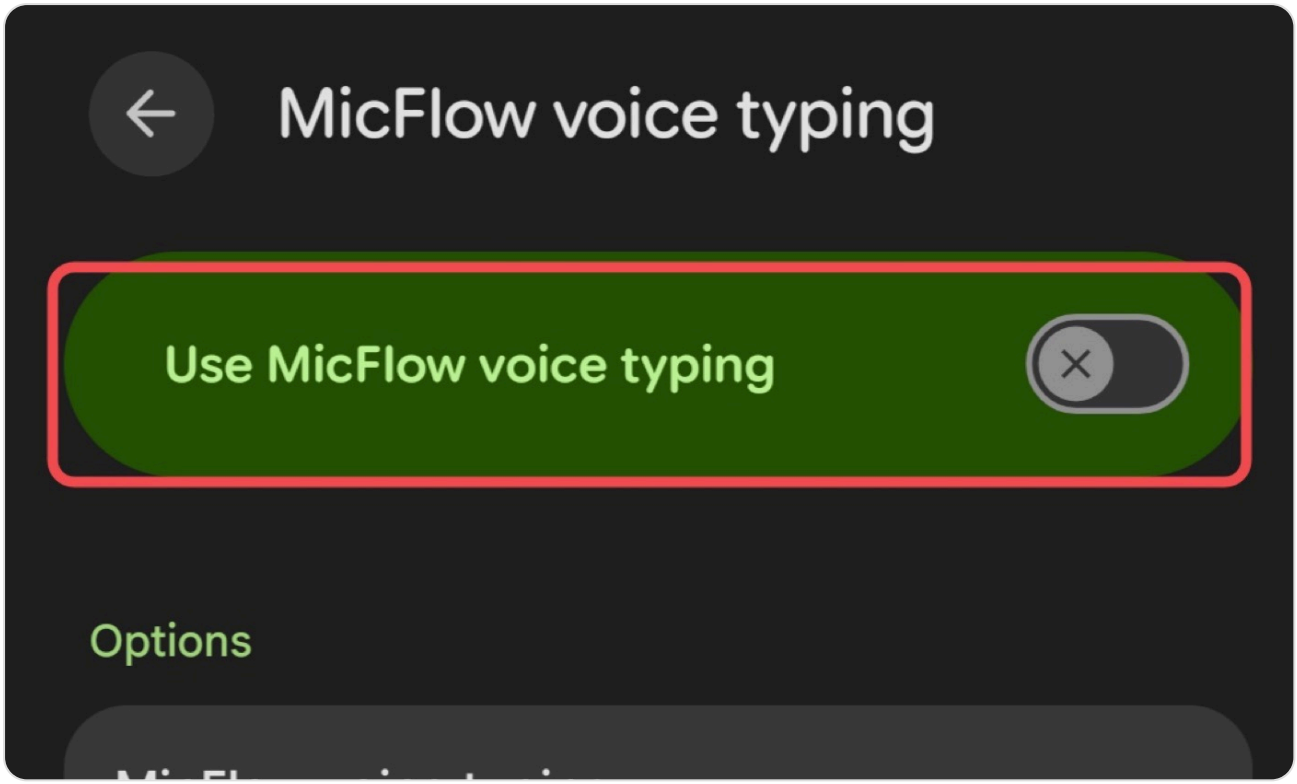


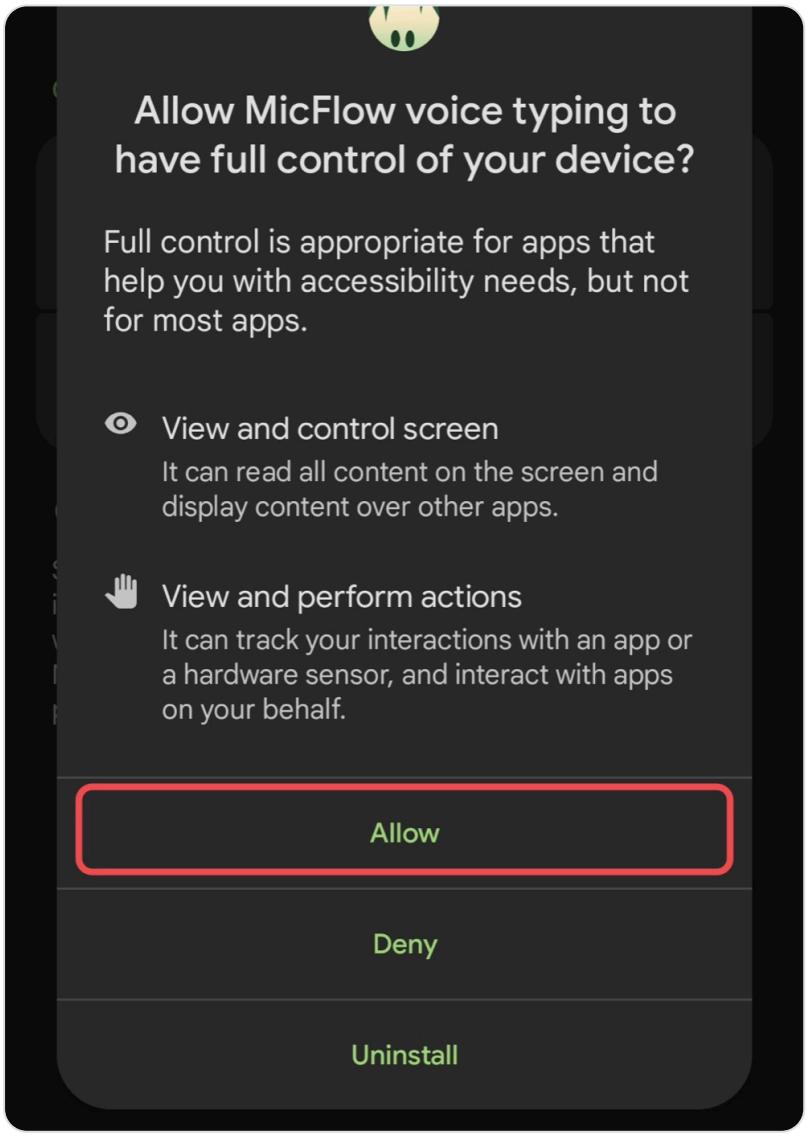
13 Open MicFlow's **App info** (Settings › Apps › MicFlow, or the button in MicFlow), tap ⋮ at the top right and choose **Allow restricted settings**. Confirm with your PIN or fingerprint; Android confirms *Restricted settings allowed for MicFlow*.

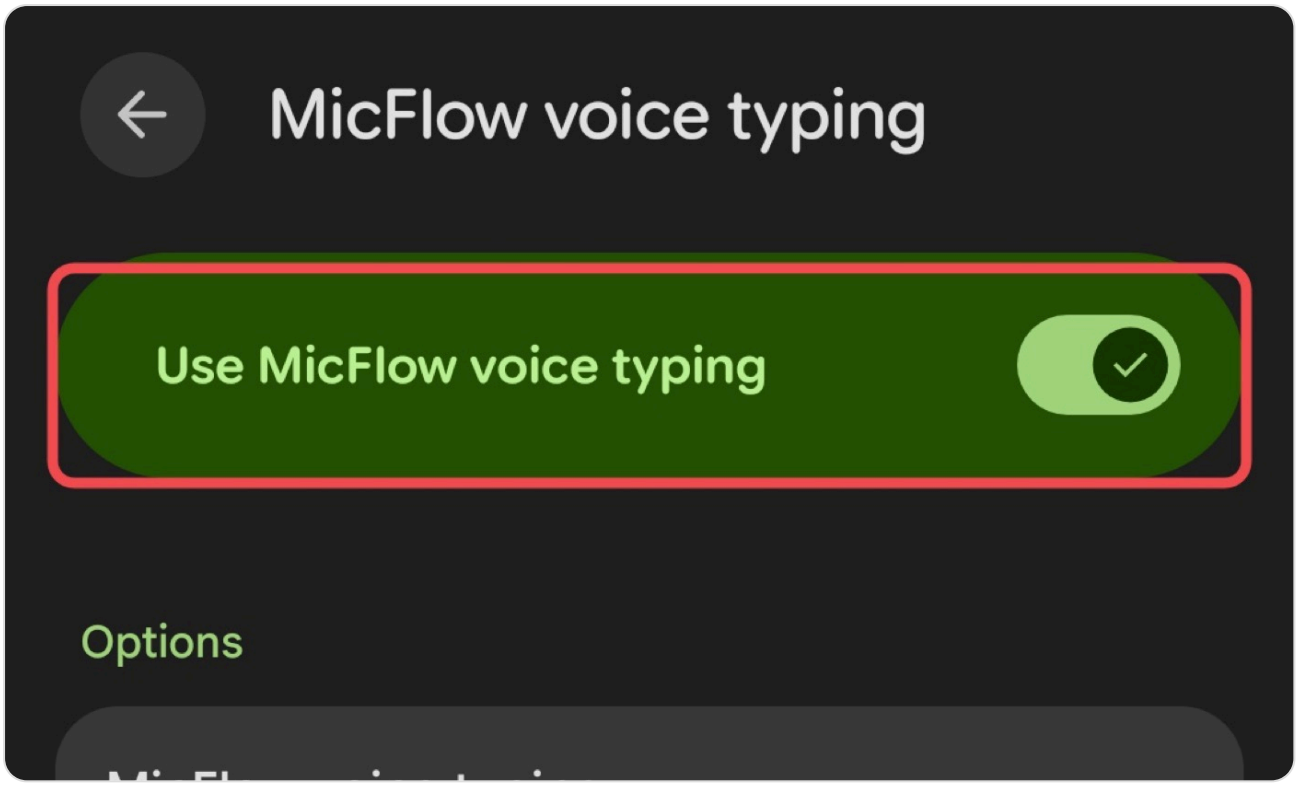




14 Back in **Accessibility › MicFlow voice typing**, turn on **Use MicFlow voice typing** and tap **Allow**.







15 Done. Tap any text box in any app: a green round **mic bubble** appears beside it. Tap it, speak English, Bengali or both, and it types for you. It stops when you stop talking.

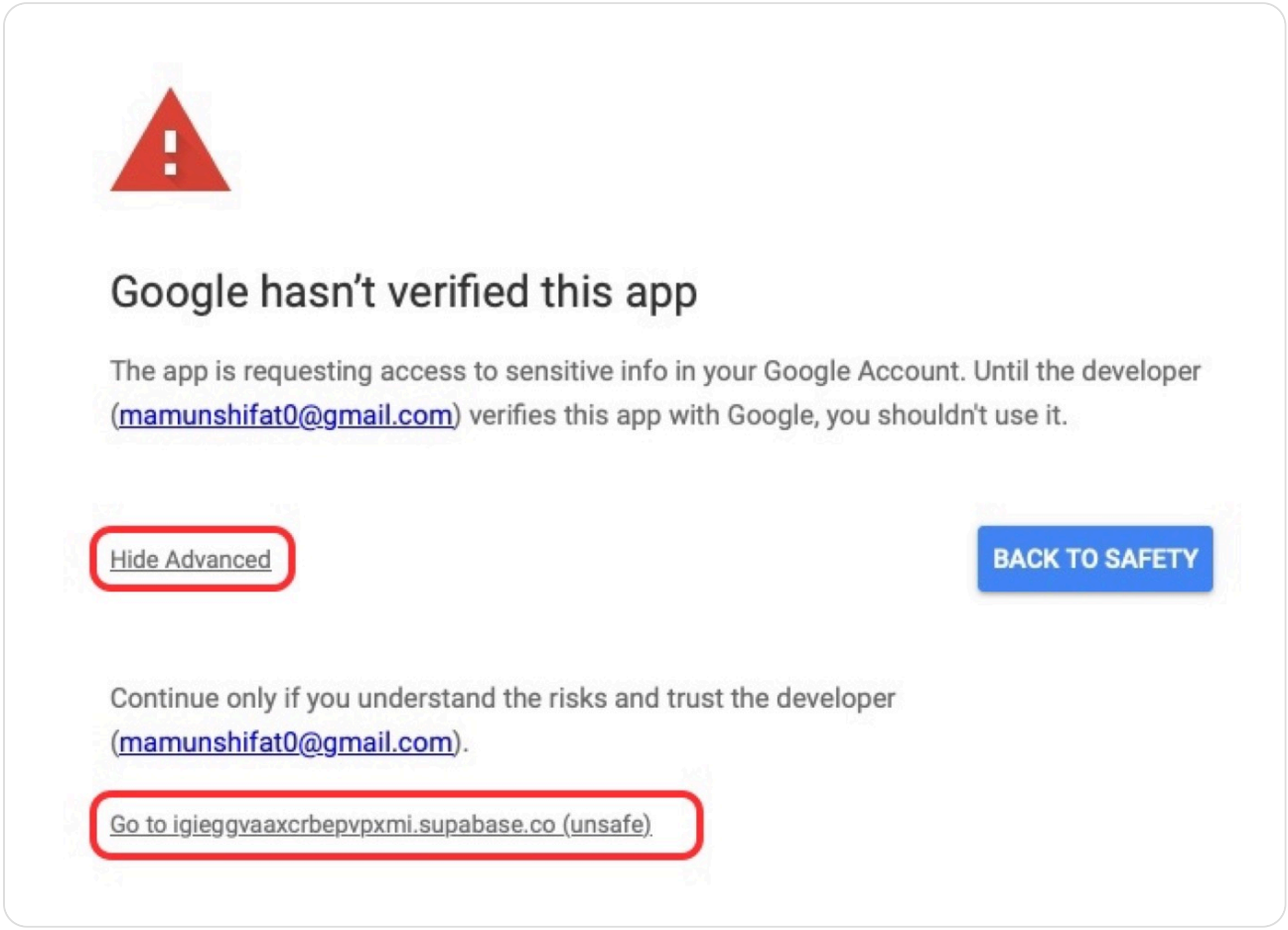
Another voice app installed? If you also use another dictation app with its own bubble (for example a grey square one), its bubble can sit on top of MicFlow's. Turn the other app off in Accessibility, or in MicFlow › Voice Typing tap **Put the bubble back beside the text box**.

3 • Signing in and your voice key

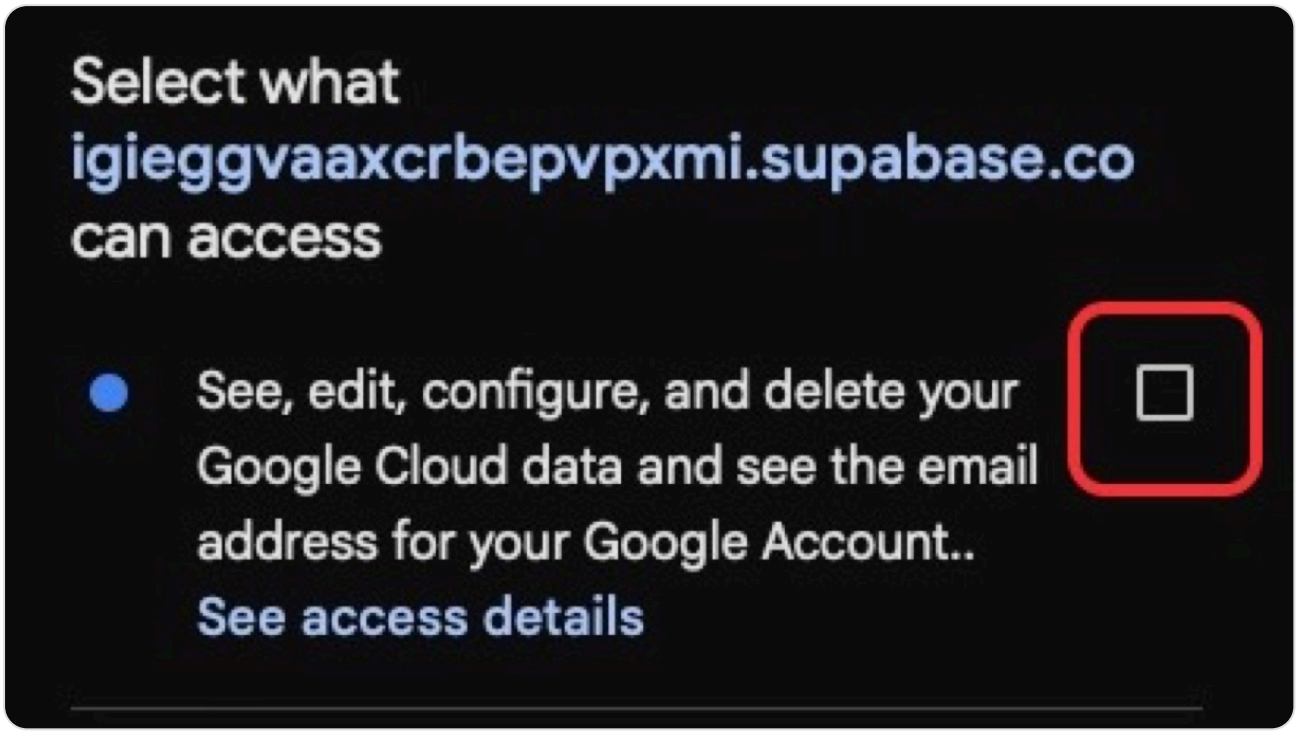
What Google shows while MicFlow makes your free key, and what to do when something goes wrong. The same on Mac and Android.

The screens you'll see

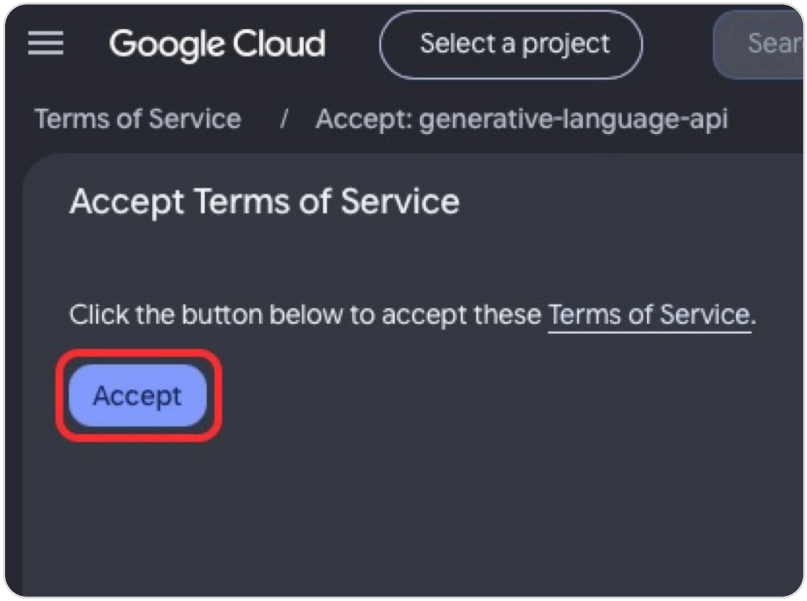
1. **"Google hasn't verified this app"**. Google's review of MicFlow isn't finished yet. Tap **Advanced**, then **Go to … (unsafe)**. MicFlow only uses this access to make your key.



2. **Tick the Google Cloud box.** This is the important one: without the tick MicFlow can't make your key. Then tap **Continue**.



3. **Accept Google's terms**, only once per account: one or two pages (the *Google APIs Terms of Service*, then the voice model's terms). MicFlow opens each page for you in the right account, ticks them off as you go, and notices by itself; if it doesn't, tap **I've accepted**.



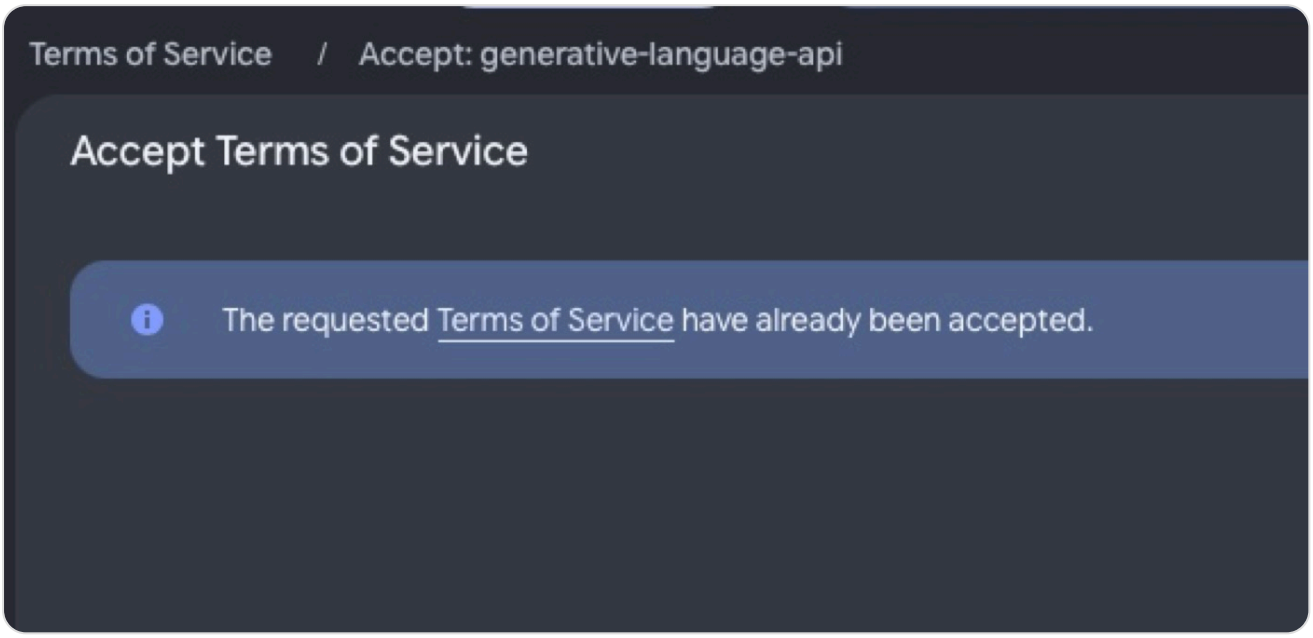
Problems and fixes

"The Google Cloud box wasn't ticked"

You continued without ticking the box on Google's permission screen. Tap **Try again** and tick it this time.

The terms page says "already been accepted", but MicFlow keeps waiting

The page opened in a different Google account than the one you signed in with. Tap your picture at the top right of the page, switch to the account MicFlow shows, and accept there.



"This Google account can't get a voice key yet"

Google decides which accounts get the free key, partly from how the account has been used. Google's own words:

> please see the following:
>
> - OAuth Rate Limits
> - Resource quota
>
> Projects are allocated to customers based on a variety of factors, including resources that legitimate customers use including customer's previous usage and history with Google Cloud, and previous abuse penalties.
>
> Projects can be for free/non-billable Cloud Services that do not require a billing account or for paid/billable Cloud Services which ***require*** a billing account.

What we found: Google accounts that hadn't been used for a long time couldn't get a key. After using them normally for a day (Gmail, YouTube, search), Google let them make one. Brand-new accounts are often refused at first too.

What to do:

- Try again with a Google account you use every day. On Google's screen, pick that account (Google shows its account list each time).
- Or use the refused account normally for a while and try again in a few hours or tomorrow.
- Or, if you made a new account just for this, use it for a day first, then try again.
- Or paste a key of your own (below).

"Your key needs replacing"

Google stopped accepting the key from the account it was made in (its free plan was turned off). Set it up again, preferably with a Google account you use regularly, or paste a key of your own.

Paste a key of your own

Shown after Google wouldn't make a key. Open the key page (MicFlow has a button for it), sign in, tap **Create API key**, copy it, paste it into MicFlow and tap **Save**. MicFlow checks it before saving. A key made in an account whose free plan is off won't work either; MicFlow will tell you.

"You closed Google's sign-in before it finished" / "Sign-in stopped on Google's screen"

The browser window was closed, or **Back to safety** was tapped on the warning screen. Sign in again and follow the three screens above.

"MicFlow couldn't reach Google"

Check your internet connection and try again.

Your key and settings on a new device

Your key is kept on your device, and your account keeps a locked (encrypted) copy. Sign in with the same Google account on another Mac or phone and voice typing works straight away, with your words, mix-ups and instructions. Logging out removes the key from that device; it comes back when you log in again.

4 • Updates and notifications

Mac: MicFlow checks for new versions by itself and usually installs them on its own. When a new version is out you also get a notification with an **Update now** button: one click and MicFlow updates and restarts. New posts in **What's New** arrive as notifications too; click one to read it.

Android: MicFlow checks about every hour and notifies you about a new version and new What's New posts. Tap **Update now**: MicFlow downloads the update and Android shows its installer, where you tap **Update** (Android always asks you to confirm an install). The first time, Android may ask you to allow MicFlow to install apps: turn on **Allow from this source**.

Updates never reset your settings, shortcuts, words or key.

Need help or have an idea? Open **Settings › Feature Requests** in MicFlow to post it, vote, and comment.